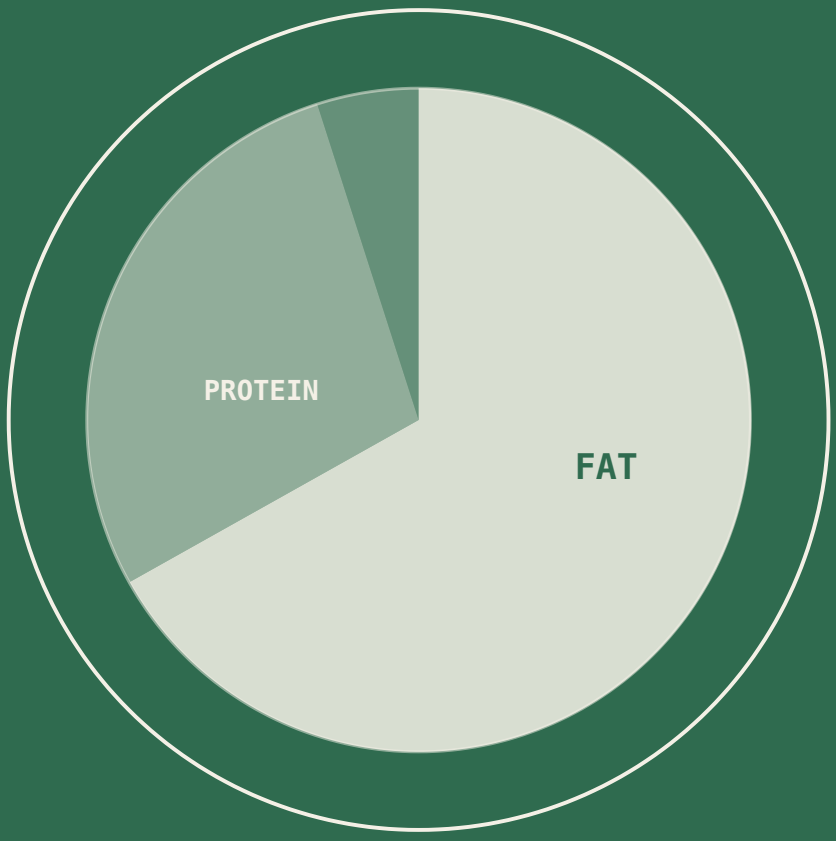


The Recipe Vault · Vol. 02

Keto Kitchen

Low-carb cooking, explained

SchoolAura

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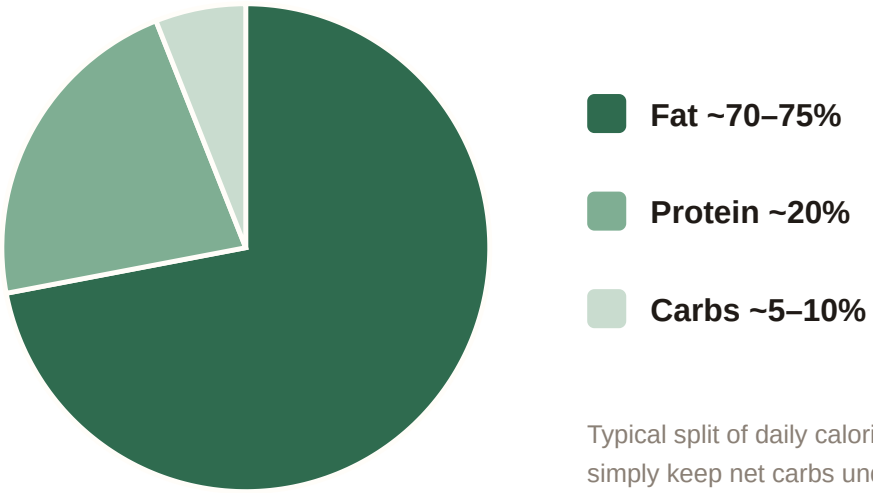
Start here

Please read first. This book is general information about a way of eating, not medical advice. Talk to your doctor before starting a ketogenic diet, especially if you take medication for diabetes or blood pressure, are pregnant or breastfeeding, have kidney, liver, pancreas or gallbladder conditions, or have a history of disordered eating. Keto isn't right for everyone, and that's fine.

What keto is

A **ketogenic (keto) diet** is a very low-carbohydrate, higher-fat way of eating. When you eat very few carbs, your body runs low on its usual fuel (glucose) and starts burning more fat, producing **ketones** that your brain and muscles can use. This state is called **ketosis**.

Most people eat keto by keeping **net carbs between 20 and 50 g a day**, eating a moderate amount of protein, and getting the rest of their energy from fats.



A common daily calorie split on keto. You don't need to track percentages: counting net carbs is enough for most people.

Net carbs

Net carbs = total carbohydrates − fibre. Fibre isn't digested into sugar, so it's subtracted. Many low-carb sweeteners such as **erythritol** and **allulose** are also usually subtracted, because they have little effect on blood sugar. Other sugar alcohols like maltitol raise blood sugar more, so count about half of them.

In Canada, the Nutrition Facts table lists carbohydrate, fibre and sugars. Subtract the fibre line from the carbohydrate line.

> **Example:** a serving of almond flour lists 6 g carbohydrate and 3 g fibre. Net carbs = 6 − 3 = **3 g**.

How much protein?

Enough to keep you full and protect your muscles: roughly a **palm-sized portion at each meal**. You don't need to eat huge amounts of protein, and you don't need to fear it.

The first two weeks: keto flu

When you cut carbs, your body releases water and salts. In the first days, some people feel tired, foggy, headachy or irritable. This is often called **keto flu**, and it's mostly caused by low fluids and electrolytes.

To feel better:

- **Drink more water** than usual.
- **Salt your food** and consider a cup of broth daily.
- Eat **potassium-rich** keto foods: avocado, spinach, mushrooms, salmon.
- **Magnesium** from nuts, seeds, leafy greens and dark chocolate.
- Go easy on hard exercise for the first week.

If symptoms are severe or don't improve within a couple of weeks, stop and speak to your doctor.

Recipe numbers in this book

Net carbs per serving are **estimates** calculated from standard nutrition data. Brands vary, so check your labels if you track closely.

CHAPTER

What to eat

Eat freely

GROUP	EXAMPLES
Meat and poultry	Chicken thighs, beef, lamb, pork, turkey
Fish and seafood	Salmon, sardines, trout, tuna, shrimp, mussels
Eggs	Any style
Low-carb vegetables	Spinach, lettuce, kale, zucchini, cauliflower, broccoli, cabbage, asparagus, green beans, mushrooms, cucumber, peppers
Healthy fats	Olive oil, avocado oil, butter, ghee, coconut oil
Full-fat dairy	Cheese, paneer, cream, sour cream, plain Greek yogurt (small portions)

In moderation

GROUP	WATCH OUT FOR
Nuts and seeds	Easy to overeat. Almonds, walnuts, pecans, macadamias, chia and flax are lowest in net carbs
Berries	Raspberries and blackberries are lowest. About ½ cup at a time
Onions, garlic, tomatoes	Use as flavouring rather than as the main ingredient
Dark chocolate (85%+)	A square or two
Alcohol	Dry wine and plain spirits have few carbs, but alcohol slows fat burning and lowers willpower

Avoid or keep very small

GROUP	EXAMPLES
Sugar	Sugar, honey, maple syrup, sweets, regular soft drinks, juice
Grains and starches	Bread, pasta, rice, oats, cereal, crackers, flour tortillas
Starchy vegetables	Potatoes, sweet potatoes, corn, peas
Legumes	Beans, lentils, chickpeas (high in carbs, though healthy in other diets)
Most fruit	Bananas, grapes, mango, dried fruit
"Low-fat" products	Often have added sugar to replace the fat

Easy swaps

INSTEAD OF	TRY
Rice	Cauliflower rice
Pasta	Zucchini noodles, shirataki noodles
Tortillas and buns	Large lettuce leaves
Mashed potato	Mashed cauliflower with butter
Flour for baking	Almond flour, coconut flour
Sugar	Erythritol, monk fruit or allulose blends
Crisps	Cheese crisps, pork rinds, nuts

A sample week

Snacks if needed: cheese crisps, a fat bomb, olives, a handful of almonds.

DAY	BREAKFAST	LUNCH	DINNER
Mon	Spinach & feta egg muffins	Chicken cobb salad	Garlic butter salmon
Tue	Coconut chia pudding	Tuna-stuffed avocados	Keto butter chicken
Wed	Egg muffins (batch)	Leftover butter chicken	Lettuce-wrap beef tacos
Thu	Cream cheese pancakes	Zucchini noodles with pesto	Creamy Tuscan chicken
Fri	Chia pudding (batch)	Leftover Tuscan chicken	Paneer tikka skewers
Sat	Eggs, bacon, avocado	Cauliflower fried rice	Garlic butter salmon
Sun	Cream cheese pancakes	Cobb salad	Butter chicken

CHAPTER

Breakfast

BREAKFAST · BATCH COOK

RECIPE 01

Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins

Make twelve on Sunday and breakfast is ready all week. Reheat in 30 seconds or eat cold.

Makes 12 | Serves 4 | Prep 10 min | Bake 20 min | ≈ 3 g net carbs per 3 muffins

INGREDIENTS

- 10 large eggs
- 60 ml (¼ cup) whipping cream
- 60 g (2 cups) baby spinach, chopped
- 100 g feta, crumbled
- ½ red pepper, finely diced
- ½ tsp salt, ¼ tsp black pepper
- Butter or oil, for the tin

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350°F (175°C). Grease a 12-cup muffin tin well, or use silicone cups.
2. Whisk the eggs, cream, salt and pepper in a large jug.
3. Divide the spinach, pepper and feta between the cups.
4. Pour the egg mixture over, filling each cup about three-quarters full.
5. Bake for 18–22 minutes, until puffed and set in the middle.
6. Cool for 5 minutes before removing. Store in the fridge for up to 4 days.

NOTES

- Swap in cooked bacon, mushrooms, cheddar or chopped green onion.

Coconut Chia Pudding

Creamy, filling and ready when you wake up. Make two jars at once.

Serves 2 | Prep 5 min | Chill 4 hours or overnight | ≈ 4 g net carbs per serving

INGREDIENTS

- 3 tbsp (36 g) chia seeds
- 120 ml (½ cup) full-fat canned coconut milk
- 120 ml (½ cup) water or unsweetened almond milk
- ½ tsp vanilla extract
- Keto sweetener to taste (about 1–2 tsp)
- 30 g (¼ cup) raspberries, to serve

METHOD

1. Stir the chia, coconut milk, water, vanilla and sweetener together in a jar.
2. Wait 5 minutes and stir again, breaking up any clumps.
3. Cover and refrigerate for at least 4 hours or overnight.
4. Stir, then top with raspberries.

NOTES

- Add 1 tbsp cocoa powder for a chocolate version (+1 g net carbs).

Cream Cheese Pancakes

Soft, slightly sweet pancakes with a crêpe-like texture. Great with butter and a few berries.

Serves 2 (6 small pancakes) | Prep 5 min | Cook 10 min | ≈ 4 g net carbs per serving

INGREDIENTS

- 2 large eggs
- 60 g (2 oz) cream cheese, softened
- 30 g (⅓ cup) almond flour
- ½ tsp baking powder
- Pinch of cinnamon and salt
- Butter, for the pan

METHOD

1. Blend or whisk all the ingredients until completely smooth. Rest for 2 minutes.
2. Heat a non-stick pan over medium-low heat and add a little butter.
3. Pour in 3 tbsp of batter per pancake. Cook for 2 minutes until bubbles appear and the edges set.
4. Flip carefully and cook for 1 minute more.

NOTES

- Keep the heat low: these brown quickly and are delicate to flip.

CHAPTER

Lunch

LUNCH RECIPE 04

Chicken Cobb Salad

A big, satisfying salad with every component you want: crisp bacon, creamy avocado, eggs and blue cheese.

Serves 2 | Prep 15 min | ≈ 5 g net carbs per serving

INGREDIENTS

- 1 head romaine, chopped (about 4 cups)
- 250 g cooked chicken, sliced
- 2 hard-boiled eggs, quartered
- 4 slices bacon, cooked and crumbled
- 1 avocado, diced
- 6 cherry tomatoes, halved
- 40 g blue cheese, crumbled

Dressing

- 3 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tbsp red wine vinegar
- 1 tsp Dijon mustard
- Salt and pepper

METHOD

1. Shake the dressing ingredients together in a jar.
2. Lay the romaine on two plates.
3. Arrange the chicken, eggs, bacon, avocado, tomatoes and cheese in rows on top.
4. Drizzle with dressing just before eating.

NOTES

- Pack the dressing separately if taking this to work.

Cauliflower Fried Rice with Shrimp

All the flavour of takeout fried rice for a fraction of the carbs.

Serves 2 | Prep 10 min | Cook 10 min | ≈ 9 g net carbs per serving

INGREDIENTS

- 400 g riced cauliflower, fresh or frozen
- 250 g raw shrimp, peeled
- 2 large eggs, beaten
- 2 green onions, sliced
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tsp grated ginger
- 2 tbsp tamari or soy sauce
- 1 tbsp toasted sesame oil
- 1 tbsp avocado oil

METHOD

1. Heat the avocado oil in a large pan or wok over high heat. Cook the shrimp for 2 minutes until pink. Remove.
2. Pour in the eggs, scramble quickly and push to one side.
3. Add the garlic, ginger and white parts of the green onions. Stir for 30 seconds.
4. Add the cauliflower and stir-fry for 4–5 minutes until tender and slightly toasted.
5. Return the shrimp, add the tamari and sesame oil, and toss. Top with green onion tops.

NOTES

- If using frozen cauliflower, cook it first until the water evaporates, so the rice isn't soggy.

Zucchini Noodles with Pesto & Chicken

Fresh and fast. Don't overcook the noodles; they should keep a little bite.

Serves 2 | Prep 10 min | Cook 5 min | ≈ 7 g net carbs per serving

INGREDIENTS

- 2 medium zucchini, spiralised
- 250 g cooked chicken, sliced
- 4 tbsp basil pesto
- 6 cherry tomatoes, halved
- 20 g parmesan, shaved
- 1 tbsp olive oil, salt and pepper

METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a large pan over medium-high heat.
2. Add the zucchini noodles and toss for 1–2 minutes, just until warm.
3. Take the pan off the heat and stir in the pesto and chicken.
4. Serve topped with tomatoes and parmesan.

NOTES

- Check pesto labels: some add sugar or cashews. Homemade or Italian-style is lowest in carbs.

Tuna-Stuffed Avocados

Five minutes, no cooking, and very filling.

Serves 2 | Prep 5 min | ≈ 3 g net carbs per serving

INGREDIENTS

- 1 large ripe avocado
- 1 can (140 g drained) tuna
- 2 tbsp mayonnaise
- 1 celery stalk, finely diced
- 1 tbsp finely chopped red onion
- 1 tbsp lemon juice
- Salt, pepper, paprika

METHOD

1. Mix the tuna, mayonnaise, celery, onion and lemon juice. Season well.
2. Halve the avocado, remove the stone and scoop out a little extra flesh to widen the hollow. Chop it into the tuna.
3. Pile the tuna into the avocado halves and sprinkle with paprika.

CHAPTER

Dinner

DINNER · FAMILY FAVOURITE

RECIPE 08

Keto Butter Chicken

Rich, mildly spiced and creamy. Serve with cauliflower rice or a crisp salad.

Serves 4 | Prep 15 min plus 30 min marinating | Cook 30 min

≈ 7 g net carbs per serving (≈ 11 g with cauliflower rice)

INGREDIENTS

700 g boneless chicken thighs, cut into bite-size pieces

Marinade

60 g (¼ cup) full-fat plain Greek yogurt

1 tbsp lemon juice

2 tsp garam masala

1 tsp turmeric

1 tsp Kashmiri chilli powder (or ½ tsp paprika + pinch of cayenne)

1 tsp salt

Sauce

3 tbsp butter

1 small onion, finely chopped

3 garlic cloves, minced

1 tbsp grated ginger

200 g (¾ cup) tomato passata

1 tsp garam masala, ½ tsp cumin, 1 tsp paprika

1 tsp dried fenugreek leaves (kasuri methi), optional

150 ml (⅔ cup) whipping cream

METHOD

1. Mix the chicken with the marinade ingredients and leave for at least 30 minutes (or overnight in the fridge).
2. Melt 1 tbsp butter in a large pan over medium-high heat. Brown the chicken in batches, 3–4 minutes per batch. It doesn't need to be cooked through. Set aside.
3. Melt the rest of the butter. Cook the onion for 6–8 minutes until soft and golden.
4. Add the garlic and ginger for 1 minute, then the spices for 30 seconds.
5. Stir in the passata and simmer for 8 minutes until thick.
6. Add the cream, fenugreek and chicken. Simmer for 10 minutes until the chicken is cooked through (74°C / 165°F).
7. Taste for salt and serve with coriander.

NOTES

- Blend the sauce before adding the chicken for a restaurant-smooth texture.

- Fresh coriander, to serve

Garlic Butter Salmon with Asparagus

Twenty minutes on one tray. Lemon, garlic and butter do all the work.

Serves 2 | Prep 5 min | Cook 15 min | ≈ 5 g net carbs per serving

INGREDIENTS

- 2 salmon fillets (about 300 g total)
- 300 g asparagus, woody ends snapped off
- 3 tbsp butter, melted
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- ½ lemon, sliced, plus juice of the other half
- Salt, pepper, chopped parsley

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 400°F (200°C) and line a tray with parchment.
2. Toss the asparagus with half the melted butter, salt and pepper and spread on the tray.
3. Place the salmon in the middle. Mix the remaining butter with the garlic and lemon juice and spoon over the fish. Top with lemon slices.
4. Roast for 12–15 minutes, until the salmon flakes easily.
5. Scatter with parsley and spoon the pan juices over.

Lettuce-Wrap Beef Tacos

All the fun of taco night. Set everything out and let everyone build their own.

Serves 4 | Prep 15 min | Cook 10 min | ≈ 5 g net carbs per serving

INGREDIENTS

- 500 g lean ground beef
- 60 ml (¼ cup) water
- 1 head butter lettuce, leaves separated
- 100 g cheddar, grated
- 120 g (½ cup) sour cream
- 1 avocado, sliced
- 80 g (⅓ cup) salsa, no sugar added
- Lime wedges and coriander

Taco seasoning

- 2 tsp chilli powder, 1 tsp cumin, 1 tsp paprika
- ½ tsp each garlic powder, onion powder, dried oregano
- ¾ tsp salt

METHOD

1. Brown the beef in a large pan over medium-high heat, breaking it up, for 6–8 minutes.
2. Pour off excess fat. Add the seasoning and water and simmer for 2–3 minutes until saucy.
3. Spoon into lettuce leaves and top with cheese, sour cream, avocado and salsa.

NOTES

- Shop-bought taco mixes often contain sugar and starch. The homemade blend takes one minute.

Paneer Tikka Skewers

Smoky, spiced paneer and peppers from the oven or grill. A vegetarian keto favourite.

Serves 3 | Prep 15 min plus 30 min marinating | Cook 15 min | ≈ 8 g net carbs per serving

INGREDIENTS

- 400 g paneer, cut into 2.5 cm cubes
- 1 green pepper, cut into squares
- ½ red onion, cut into chunks

Marinade

- 120 g (½ cup) full-fat Greek yogurt
- 1 tbsp lemon juice
- 1 tbsp oil
- 2 tsp ginger-garlic paste
- 1 tsp Kashmiri chilli powder, 1 tsp garam masala
- ½ tsp turmeric, ½ tsp cumin, 1 tsp dried fenugreek leaves
- ¾ tsp salt

METHOD

1. Whisk the marinade, add the paneer and vegetables and coat gently. Leave for 30 minutes.
2. If using wooden skewers, soak them in water while the paneer marinates.
3. Heat the oven to 450°F (230°C) or a grill to high. Thread paneer and vegetables onto skewers.
4. Cook for 12–15 minutes, turning once, until charred at the edges.
5. Serve with lemon wedges and a cucumber-mint yogurt.

Creamy Tuscan Chicken

Golden chicken in a garlicky cream sauce with spinach and sun-dried tomatoes.

Serves 4 | Prep 10 min | Cook 25 min | ≈ 5 g net carbs per serving

INGREDIENTS

- 700 g chicken breasts, halved horizontally into thin cutlets
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 40 g sun-dried tomatoes in oil, chopped
- 240 ml (1 cup) whipping cream
- 60 g parmesan, grated
- 60 g (2 cups) baby spinach
- 1 tsp Italian seasoning, salt and pepper

METHOD

1. Season the chicken with salt, pepper and Italian seasoning.
2. Heat the oil in a large pan over medium-high heat and cook the chicken 4–5 minutes per side until golden and cooked through. Set aside.
3. Lower the heat. Add the garlic and sun-dried tomatoes and cook for 1 minute.
4. Pour in the cream and simmer for 3 minutes. Stir in the parmesan until melted.
5. Add the spinach and stir until wilted. Return the chicken and spoon the sauce over.

CHAPTER

Snacks & sweets

SNACK RECIPE 13

Crispy Cheese Crisps

One ingredient, crunchy like a cracker. Great for dips or on their own.

Serves 2 (about 12 crisps) · Prep 2 min · Bake 6 min · ≈ 1 g net carbs per serving

INGREDIENTS

- 100 g finely grated parmesan or aged cheddar
- Optional: pinch of chilli flakes, everything bagel seasoning or dried herbs

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 400°F (200°C) and line a tray with parchment.
2. Place tablespoon mounds of cheese on the tray, 5 cm apart, and flatten slightly. Add any seasoning.
3. Bake for 5–7 minutes until golden at the edges.
4. Cool on the tray for 5 minutes; they crisp as they cool.

Chocolate Almond Fat Bombs

Rich, bite-sized chocolate treats to stop sweet cravings.

Makes 12 | Prep 10 min | Freeze 30 min | ≈ 1 g net carbs each

INGREDIENTS

- 120 g (½ cup) coconut oil, softened
- 125 g (½ cup) unsweetened almond butter
- 3 tbsp (15 g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 2–3 tbsp powdered keto sweetener, to taste
- ½ tsp vanilla extract, pinch of flaky salt

METHOD

1. Stir everything together until smooth. Warm gently if the coconut oil is firm.
2. Spoon into 12 silicone moulds or a lined mini muffin tin.
3. Freeze for 30 minutes until firm. Store in the fridge or freezer.

90-Second Mug Bread

A quick slice of bread for sandwiches or toast. Cooks in the microwave.

Makes 1 roll (2 slices) · Prep 2 min · Cook 90 sec · ≈ 2.5 g net carbs

INGREDIENTS

- 3 tbsp (21 g) almond flour
- 1 large egg
- 1 tbsp butter, melted
- ½ tsp baking powder
- Pinch of salt

METHOD

1. Mix everything in a greased, straight-sided mug or ramekin until smooth.
2. Microwave on high for 90 seconds, until set and springy.
3. Turn out, cool for 2 minutes and slice in half. Toast in a pan with butter for the best texture.

Chocolate Avocado Mousse

Silky and rich. The avocado makes it creamy; you won't taste it.

Serves 4 | Prep 10 min | Chill 30 min | ≈ 3 g net carbs per serving

INGREDIENTS

- 2 ripe avocados
- 4 tbsp (20 g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 120 ml (½ cup) whipping cream or coconut milk
- 3–4 tbsp powdered keto sweetener, to taste
- 1 tsp vanilla extract, pinch of salt

METHOD

1. Blend everything in a food processor until completely smooth, scraping the sides.
2. Taste and add more sweetener or cocoa if needed.
3. Spoon into four small glasses and chill for 30 minutes.
4. Top with a few raspberries or whipped cream.

Almond Flour Shortbread

Buttery, crumbly cookies with only four main ingredients.

Makes 16 · Prep 15 min · Bake 10–12 min · ≈ 1.5 g net carbs each

INGREDIENTS

- 200 g (2 cups) almond flour
- 85 g (6 tbsp) butter, softened
- 65 g (⅓ cup) granulated keto sweetener
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- Pinch of salt

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350°F (175°C) and line a tray with parchment.
2. Beat the butter and sweetener until creamy, then mix in the vanilla, salt and almond flour to form a dough.
3. Roll into 16 balls and flatten to 1 cm thick with a fork.
4. Bake for 10–12 minutes until golden at the edges.
5. Cool completely on the tray; they firm up as they cool.

CHAPTER

Shopping list

A starter shop for the sample week, for one or two people. Adjust quantities to your household.

- **Protein:** chicken thighs (700 g), chicken breasts (700 g), cooked chicken (500 g), salmon fillets (4), ground beef (500 g), raw shrimp (250 g), canned tuna (2), bacon, 2 dozen eggs, paneer (400 g)
- **Dairy:** butter, whipping cream (500 ml), cream cheese, feta, parmesan, cheddar, blue cheese, sour cream, full-fat Greek yogurt
- **Vegetables:** baby spinach, romaine, butter lettuce, zucchini (2), riced cauliflower (800 g), asparagus, peppers, celery, cherry tomatoes, green onions, onion, garlic, ginger, lemons, limes, coriander, parsley
- **Fruit:** avocados (6), raspberries
- **Pantry:** olive oil, avocado oil, coconut oil, sesame oil, tamari, Dijon mustard, red wine vinegar, mayonnaise, pesto, tomato passata, sun-dried tomatoes, salsa
- **Baking and snacks:** almond flour, chia seeds, almond butter, cocoa powder, keto sweetener, baking powder, canned coconut milk, almonds
- **Spices:** garam masala, turmeric, Kashmiri chilli, cumin, paprika, chilli powder, Italian seasoning, dried fenugreek, cinnamon